**Parishes of Camus, Clonleigh and Leckpatrick**
**Fifth Sunday of Easter – Year A – 3rd May 2026**
**Parish Clergy**

Fr Michael McCaughey, PP: (028) 71882274 / (028) 71882215
Fr Declan Boland (priest in residence)
**Email**: leckpatrickparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website**: www.leckpatrickparish.com
**Email**: strabaneparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.camusparish.com
**Email:** clonleighparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website**: www.clonleighparish.com

**Thoughts on the Gospel (John 14:1-12)**

Jesus speaks tenderly to His disciples as they face uncertainty and fear. He reassures them not to be troubled, promising that He is preparing a place for them and that they know the way through Him. He reveals a deep unity with the Father, showing that to know Him is to know God. Though He is going away, He promises that those who believe in Him will continue His work and even do greater things, empowered by faith and trust. For us today, many carry quiet anxieties about the future, about purpose, direction, and belonging. Jesus' words remind us that faith is not about having every answer, but about trusting the One who does. When life feels uncertain, we are invited to anchor our hearts in a relationship, not in circumstances.

This passage challenges us to shift from fear to trust. It encourages us to live with quiet confidence, knowing that our lives are held in something greater than our present struggles. Faith becomes a daily choice, to believe that our steps matter, our lives are guided, and even small acts done in love carry eternal weight. We live in a time marked by division, uncertainty, and a constant search for meaning. This passage calls the world back to a way rooted in truth, humility, and self-giving love. It is about ordinary people becoming channels of hope in extraordinary ways. In today's context, this means choosing kindness over anger, truth over deception, and unity over division. Every act of goodness, no matter how small, becomes part of a larger work that brings light into darkness.

This passage invites us to a deeper trust. It calls us to believe that our lives are not drifting aimlessly, but moving toward a meaningful destination. It challenges us to live in such a way that others can glimpse hope through us. And assures us that even in a changing and uncertain world, there is a steady, unshakable foundation available to all who are willing to trust. When we embrace this message, we do not just find comfort; we become instruments of comfort. We do not just receive direction; we become guides to others. And in doing so, we participate in something far greater than ourselves: a movement of faith, hope, and love that has the power to renew both hearts and the world.

***'Do not let your hearts be troubled. Trust in God still, and trust in Me.'***

We pray for children and families of our parish pastoral area who, in the coming week, will receive their First Holy Communion as follows:

**Friday 8th May at 1.00 pm:** Strabane PS in Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

**Friday 8th May at 3.30pm:** St Mary's PS, Cloughcor in St Mary's Church, Cloughcor

**Saturday 9th May at 10.30 am:** St Catherine's PS in Immaculate Conception Church

**Saturday 9th May at 1.30 pm:** Scoil Naomh Padraig / Scoil Mhuire gan Smal / Scoil Naomh Colmcille in St Patrick's Church, Murlog.

**Rosary at the Grotto, Porthall** will take place on Friday 15th May at 7.00 pm, led by Fr McCaughey. All parishioners are invited to attend.

**Anniversaries** Danny McLaughlin, Danny Boy McLaughlin, Eddie Gallagher, Charlie Dillon, Elsie Sharkey, Marie Kelly, Tony O'Connor, Myra Friel, Marcella McCarron, Mac McCauley, Margaret Kennedy, Bridie Doherty, Elsie Duncan, Patsy McCallion, Hugh Harley, Hugh McGettigan, Marie Kelly (Murlog), Kevin McGonagle, Tillie McGranaghan, Annabelle McGranaghan, Tony (Thomas) Kelly, Paul Boggs, William Boggs, Damien Friel, Joseph Ferguson, Jack Carron, Elizabeth Carron, Trina Hannigan, Ellen Doherty, Tony O'Connor. May they rest in peace.

**9.45am Mass** on Sundays in Murlog Chapel is live on Finn Valley Community Radio.

**Thank You** for your generosity to last week's collections:
**Leckpatrick:** £1,509.09
**Clonleigh**: €1,385.76
**Camus:** £1,718.90
Thanks to those who pay by standing order.

**Readings for Sunday 10th May:**
**First Reading:** Acts 8:5-8, 14-17
**Psalm:** 65: 1-7, 16, 20
**Second Reading:** 1 Peter 3:15-18
**Gospel:** John 14:15-21

**Saints This Week:**
**Monday:** St Conleth, bishop
**Tuesday:** Blessed Edmund Rice, religious

**Monthly Mass in Honour of St Pio** will be celebrated on Wednesday 6th May at 7.00 pm in Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane. We ask God's blessing on all through the intercession of St Pio. Everyone welcome.

**The St John Vianney Branch of the Vocations Society of St Joseph** will meet on Tuesday 5th May in Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane with rosary after 10 am Mass and continue in St Pat's Hall. Everyone welcome.

**Omagh Charismatic Prayer Group** Mgr Barney McAleer, retired SMA priest, will give a talk on 'Our Lady, our Mother' on Thursday 7th May at 8 pm in the pastoral centre, Brook Street, Omagh. All are welcome.

**The Little Way Novena in St Eugene's Cathedral: 9th - 17th May** Theme: 'My peace consists in remaining little". The Novena begins at 7.30 pm Mass on Saturday 9th May with the Sacrament of the Sick. Devotions and talk on Sunday 10th May at 6 pm. Monday - Friday (11th - 15th May), Novena Masses at 6.30 am and 10 am each morning and an evening service with a guest speaker at 7.30 pm. Saturday, 16th May 10 am Mass for those who have died. The Novena will close on Sunday 17th May at 3 pm with blessing of roses. Everyone is welcome to St Eugene's Cathedral for this time of prayer and petition. Follow via https://www.steugenes.com/webcam.html

**Derry Diocesan Pilgrimage To Knock Shrine** on Saturday 6th June, in conjunction with All Ireland Rosary Rally. Buses will leave St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry at 8 am. Cost £50 (includes dinner in Knock House Hotel following Mass in the Basilica). Please contact Karen: 028 71262894 / cathedral@derrydiocese.org

**Pilgrimage to Lourdes** 3rd - 8th July 2026. Flights from Derry. Full board £899. Contact Maria at 028 81648357 or WhatsApp 07768 395038 for further details.

**Services of Intercession for the Dead** take place in our pastoral area as follows:

**St Patrick's Church, Murlog** - Friday 8th May at 6.30 pm

**St Joseph's Church, Glenmornan** - Saturday 9th May at 6.00 pm

**Strabane Cemetery & Camus** - Sunday 10th May at 2.00 pm

**Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road** - Sunday 10th May at 4.30 pm

**St Mary's Church, Cloughcor** - Sunday 10th May at 6.30 pm.

A voluntary collection for maintenance of cemeteries will be taken up. Thank you. You are asked to co-operate with stewards. Thank you for your ongoing commitment in remembering your loved ones by visiting and maintaining their graves. *May their souls and the souls of all the faithful departed, through the mercy of God, rest in peace.*

**St Eugene's Cathedral Scholars 26/27** Open to all full-time students over 16, the choral scholars sing with the cathedral choir weekly and at other special events. They will receive instruction in a wide range of choral music and a stipend for their participation. To apply, please contact maghnusmonaghan@hotmail.com

**Diocesan Pilgrimage to Lough Derg -** 24th - 26th July. Visit Diocese of Derry - News - Diocese of Derry Pilgrimage to Lough Derg – July 2026

**Murlog Parish Pilgrimage To Knock Shrine *Saturday 25th July***, leaving Murlog Chapel at 7.15 am. Cost: €50 per person, (includes coach/refreshments/meal). Please contact: James: 0858767999, Mary: 0877625237 or Bernie: 078 53272541.

**Parish Bingo and Lucky Four** A warm welcome to all to St Patrick's Hall every Thursday at 8 pm. Come along for some fun and excitement and slight competition.

**Knock Pilgrimage to Pray for Peace in the Holy Land** People from all over Ireland are invited to Knock Shrine on Saturday 16th May for a special pilgrimage to pray for peace in the Holy Land. The pilgrimage, organised by the papal charity, Aid to the Church in Need, will be led by Bishop William Shomali from Bethlehem. Bishop Shomali will offer a message of hope at 11 am, and celebrate Mass at 3 pm. All are welcome. More information at www.acnireland.org

**Medjugorje Pilgrimages 2026** (45th anniversary): 24th June - 1st July. Depart Dublin - Mostar. Return Split - Dublin. €855 pps. Single room supplement: €170. For more information, please contact Ursula O Faodhagain, Castlefin 0872960562.

**Marriage Preparation Workshops** take place on May 15th / 16th and June 19th / 20th 2026. To book, please visit www.accordni.com

**Gamblers Anonymous** Is gambling affecting your life? We would like to help. Pick up the phone and ring 028 7135 1329. **Alcoholics Anonymous** Tel 90351222.

**Job Opportunity: Derry Diocesan Trust** Temporary Administrative & Financial Officer (15 hours pw), Parish of Urney & Castlefin, based in the Parochial House, Doneyloop. For application pack, please contact 028 71262302 / recruitment@derrydiocese.org Closing date 12 noon on 7th May 2026.

**Lough Derg One Day Retreats** (day of guided prayer and reflection) **May** 3,4,9,12,17,23,25, **August** 18,22,23,29,31, **Sept** 5,6,9,12,15,19,20. Adm: €50. Booking essential. **Three Day Pilgrimages** in the tradition of prayer, fasting and vigil take place from May 29th - August 15th. Adm: €85. Booking advisable. Contact +353 (0) 719861518, info@loughderg.org or visit www.loughderg.org

**Monthly Mass in Honour of Sr Clare Crockett** will be celebrated on Sunday 10th May at 7 pm in the Carmelite Retreat Centre, Termonbacca, Derry. All welcome.

**Pope Leo's Prayer Intention for May** You are invited to join people worldwide in praying for the following intention: **That everyone might have food**
Let us pray that everyone, from large producers to small consumers, be committed to avoid wasting food, and to ensure that everyone has access to quality food.

**Clonleigh Parish Draw - April 2026**

| **Prize** | **Winner** | **Promoter** |
|---|---|---|
| €1,000 | Catherine Duffy | Bernie Friel |
| €300 | Catherine Curran | Marie McDaid |
| €200 | Joe & Marie Bovaird | Jane Toland |
| €100 | Siobhan Power | Eileen McGhee |
| €100 | Shannon Dolan | Stephen McCullagh |
| €100 | Martin Gallagher | Rose Gallagher |
| €100 | Shaun Friel | Sharon Friel |
| €100 | Leah McDaid | Marie McDaid |

*Congratulations to all the winners. Thank you for your support.*

**Diocesan Youth Pilgrimage to Fatima** Those aged 16+ are invited on pilgrimage to Fatima from 3rd - 8th August. A unique experience for young people and an opportunity to engage with their peers from around the world in a faith context.
Cost: £820. Please contact bethany.doherty@derrydiocese.org / 028 71264087.

**Rosary on the Coast** takes place today (Sunday) at 3 pm at Lisfannon Beach, praying for peace, Ireland and our unborn children. Everyone welcome.

**Donegal Pro Life** is inviting support to attend the *March for Life* in Dublin on Bank Holiday Monday, 4th May. For details / to book the sponsored bus contact: Margaret on 089 2469599 or Teresa on 086 2647235 or Brian on 087 2913186.

## Weekend Mass Schedule

**Immaculate Conception:** Saturday Vigil: 4.30 pm; Sunday: 11.00 am

**Sacred Heart, Derry Road:** Sunday: 12.15 pm

**St Patrick's, Clonleigh:** Saturday Vigil: 6.30 pm; Sunday: 9.45 am

**St Joseph's, Glenmornan:** Sunday: 8.30 am (3rd May - alternate Sundays)

**St Mary's, Cloughcor:** Sunday: 8.30 am (10th May - alternate Sundays)

## Weekday Mass Schedule

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|---|---|
| **Monday:** | 7.45 am: Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road |
| | 10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford |
| **Tuesday:** | 10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane |
| **Wednesday:** | 10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford |
| | 12.00 noon: Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road |
| **Thursday:** | 10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane |
| **Friday:** | 7.45 am: Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road |
| | 10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane |

**Weddings** Please contact the parish office. At least 6 months' notice required.
**Baptisms:** Parent(s) are asked to contact the parish office.

**The Parish Pastoral Area Office**, **27 Butcher St, Strabane** covers all 3 parishes**.** **Office hours:** Monday – Thursday: 9.30 am - 4.30 pm; Friday: 9.30 am - 12.30 pm. Please feel free to call in or phone on 028 7188 2215.

**Reminder** that the deadline for parish bulletin notices is 2 pm on Wednesdays.

**A Small Collection of Candles** is available for purchase at the Pastoral Office.

A gentle reminder that we can only accept cash or cheque payments. Thank you.

**Safeguarding (Northern Ireland)** If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Adult at risk of harm or Adult in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact PSNI on 101,Western HSCT Children's Gateway Services on 028 71 314090, WHSCT Adult Gateway Services on 028 71 611366 or the Regional Emergency Social Work Service on 028 95 049999.

**Safeguarding (Republic of Ireland)** If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Vulnerable Adults within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +44 7596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact Garda Síochána Buncrana on 074 93 20540, Garda Síochána Letterkenny on 074 91 67100, TUSLA (ROI) Child and Family Agency on 074 91 02233 or HSC Adult Safeguarding, Donegal on 071 983 4660.